- **Reputation**: Research the reputation of the wallet and its team to make sure it is trustworthy.
- **Control**: Some wallets give you more control over your private keys, which can be a security advantage. Consider whether you want a wallet that gives you full control, or one that is more user-friendly but may have less control.

You can always transfer your funds to a different wallet later.

6.1 The Process of Onboarding and Securing Your bitcoin

Onboarding into ***Bitcoin*** refers to the process of acquiring and using ***bitcoin***.

Before moving any further, it's important that we learn the steps for **onboarding** and familiarize ourselves with the process for **buying** and **securing** ***bitcoin*** safely.

1. **Choose a bitcoin exchange or brokerage**: There are many different platforms that allow you to buy and sell ***bitcoin***. Choose a platform that meets your needs and is reputable.
2. **Create an account**: Follow the platform's instructions to create a new account. This may involve providing personal information and verifying your identity.
3. **Connect a payment method**: Most platforms will allow you to connect a bank account, credit card, or debit card to fund your account. Follow the platform's instructions to add your payment method.
4. **Place an order**: Once your account is set up and funded, you can place an order to buy ***bitcoin***. The platform will provide you with a price quote and you can specify the amount of ***bitcoin*** you want to buy.
5. **Confirm the transaction**: Review the details of your transaction and **confirm the purchase**. The platform will process the transaction and the ***bitcoin*** will be transferred to your account on the platform.
6. **Withdraw the** ***bitcoin***: If you want to transfer the bitcoin to a self-custodial wallet, you will need to *withdraw the bitcoin from the platform and send it to your wallet*. The platform will provide instructions for how to do this.

"Not your keys, not your coins"

This is a popular saying among ***bitcoin*** holders. It refers to the idea that if you don't have direct control over the private keys associated with your bitcoin wallet, you don't have true ownership of the coins.

The **private key** is a secret code that allows you to access your ***bitcoin*** and spend it. When you